# DA Quick Cards

The everyday jobs, one card each, in a few steps. Print them (the **PDF version** button above) and keep them by the computer. The full user guide explains everything else.

**My archive** (fill this in when DA is set up):

| **My archive** | **(write it here)** |
|---|---|
| My archives are in | |
| New photos and papers go to the archive | |
| My backup drive is | |
| For help, call or text | |

# Your desktop shortcuts

Each job starts with a double-click on a shortcut, so you never have to find a folder or type a command. A shortcut is just a door into a folder or a job: deleting a shortcut deletes nothing else. The cards use these:

| Shortcut | What it opens |
|---|---|
| **Open DA** | DA's menu, in your newest archive |
| **New photos** | The folder new photos go in |
| **New papers** | The folder new papers and scans go in |
| **Archives** | All your archives, to look at photos and papers |
| **Back up archives** | Copies everything to the backup drive |

# Card 1: Add photos from a phone or camera

1. Plug in the phone or camera (or put its memory card in the computer).
2. Double-click **New photos**.
3. Make a folder named for what happened: right-click an empty spot, **New > Folder**, and type a name like `Beach trip` or `Emma's birthday`. No date needed: DA adds it.
4. Copy the photos from the phone or camera into that folder.
5. Double-click **Open DA**, type **1** and press **Enter**.
6. Wait. DA is done when it shows **Where things stand now**.

Your photos are now in the year, in a folder like `2026-06 Beach trip`. Copies of photos you already had are set aside, not filed twice. Keep the photos on the phone until after the next backup (Card 6).

# Card 2: Add papers and scans

1. Scan the papers, or save the PDF (a bill, a statement), into **New papers**. Several at once is fine.
2. Double-click **Open DA**, type **1** and press **Enter**.
3. Wait for **Where things stand now**.

DA files each paper by the date printed on it, in a folder for its year and month.

# Card 3: Name the events in a month

For photos already filed that sit together in one month's folder.

1. Double-click **Open DA**, type **L** and press **Enter**.
2. DA lists the months. Type the number of the month and press **Enter**.
3. DA shows the photos in groups, a group for each outing or day. For each group:
   - press **Enter** to take the name shown,
   - or type a better name, like `Grandma's 80th`, and press **Enter**,
   - or type **-** and press **Enter** to leave that group where it is.
4. Give two groups the **same name** to put them in one folder.
5. Press **Enter** when DA asks to move them.

# Card 3b: Date old photos

For scanned prints and other photos DA couldn't date: they wait in **review**, a folder at a time.

1. Double-click **Open DA**, type **V** and press **Enter**. The **Dates** page opens in the browser.
2. Pick a folder at the top. Click the photos that were taken together (they get a tick).
3. The big date shows DA's best guess. Press **−** or **+** to go a month older or newer, **−−** or **++** for a year. Or click the date and type it, like `1987-03`.
4. Press **Set**. The photos show **dated** in green.
5. Do the next photos. Made a mistake? Press **Undo**.
6. When you're done, press **File dated photos** (or type **1** in DA next time).

A month is enough. If you only know the year, set it anyway: the photo waits until you know the month.

# Card 4: Look at photos and papers

1. Double-click **Archives**.
2. Open the archive for the years you want: the one ending **201x** holds 2010 to 2019.
3. Open **photos**, then **organized**, then the year, then the month or event.
4. Double-click a photo to see it. Each folder also has a **_contact-sheet.pdf**: the whole folder on a few pages, to find the photo you're after quickly.

Papers are in the same archive, under **documents**, then **organized**, then the year.

To look in a web browser instead: double-click **Open DA**, type **B** and press **Enter**.

# Card 5: Find something

1. Double-click **Archives**.
2. Click in the **Search** box at the top right of the window.
3. Type a word from the event or the paper: `Beach`, `2019`, `birthday`, `Water Company`.
4. Wait a moment for the list, then double-click what you want.

# Card 6: Back up (once a week)

1. Plug in the backup drive.
2. Double-click **Back up archives**.
3. Wait. The first time takes a long while; after that, only what changed is copied.
4. When it says **You can unplug the backup drive**, press any key, then unplug it.
5. Put the backup drive away from the computer.

If it says **The backup drive isn't there**, plug it in and try again. If it says anything else, don't try again: call for help.

# Card 7: When something looks wrong

1. **Stop.** Don't move, rename or delete anything in the archive folders yourself.
2. Take a photo of the screen with your phone, or write down what it says.
3. Call or text for help (the number is on the first page).

**Nothing is lost.** DA never deletes your photos or papers: copies are only set aside, and everything DA moves can be put back. Your helper can see your screen from their home: in Windows, click **Start**, type **Quick Assist**, and read them the code it shows.

# For the helper: setting up a computer

Once per computer, with DA installed (see *Getting started* in the user guide):

1. **Archives:** `da setup <folder>` for each decade, e.g. `D:\archives\jane-archive-202x --years 2020-2029`.
2. **Old drives:** in each archive, `da import <drives> --apply`, most complete first, then **1 Autorun** and **S Split by years**.
3. **No questions:** in the newest archive, **P Pre-run setup**: switch on **11 Location folders** and **Bypass yes**.
4. **Cameras:** share one list: `cameras_file: ..\cameras.json` in each archive's `da-archive.yaml`, then `da cameras --detect` in each, and **C Cameras** to fill in owners, film cameras and their years.
5. **Backup:** with the backup drive plugged in, `da backup --setup E:\DA-backup` (its letter). Run the **Back up archives** shortcut it makes once.
6. **Shortcuts:** right-click, **Send to > Desktop (create shortcut)**, and rename: the newest archive's **Open DA.cmd** (Open DA), its `intake\photos` (New photos) and `intake\docs` (New papers), and the folder holding the archives (Archives).

7. Fill in **My archive** on the first page, print the cards, and do Card 1 and Card 3b together once.

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